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STAFF REPORT

Date: October 20, 2026

To: Policy Committee

From: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent
Dr. Jenny Lind Withycombe, Assistant Director of Health and Physical Education

Subject: Comprehensive Health and Wellness Policy: Revision of 6.40.013-P (Comprehensive Health Education) and Rescission of 3.60.060-P (Student Wellness through Nutrition, Physical Education, Physical Activity, and School-Based Activities)

BACKGROUND

Portland Public Schools is committed to creating safe and healthy learning environments that support the academic, physical, social, and emotional development of every student. The proposed revision to Board Policy 6.40.013, Comprehensive Health Education, establishes a comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy that aligns district policy with the Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child (WSCC) framework.

The proposed policy recognizes that student health and academic success are interconnected and that supporting student wellness requires coordination across instructional, operational, clinical, and administrative functions. The policy therefore establishes a comprehensive framework addressing School Food and Nutrition, Physical Education and Physical Activity, Comprehensive Health Education, Healthy School Environments, Safe and Supportive Environments, Health Services, and Employee Wellness.

The proposed policy also formally establishes a District Wellness Council, currently referred to as a School Health Advisory Council (SHAC), to coordinate, monitor, and evaluate implementation of the policy and an annual Wellness Action Plan[1].

As part of this policy revision, staff recommends rescinding Board Policy 3.60.060-P, Student Wellness through Nutrition and Physical Activity. The proposed Comprehensive Health &

[1] Healthy, Hunger-Free Kids Act of 2010, 42 U.S.C. § 1758b. National School Lunch Program, 7 C.F.R. Part 210. School Breakfast Program, 7 C.F.R. Part 220

Wellness Policy incorporates the wellness, nutrition, physical activity, and related provisions addressed by those policies into a single comprehensive framework.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The proposed policy is related to and should be implemented in coordination with existing PPS policies addressing:

- Non-discrimination/Anti-Harassment (1.80.020-P)
- Racial Educational Equity (2.10.010-P)
- Tobacco Possession & Use (3.30.021-P)
- Student Suicide Prevention (4.30.050-P)
- Student Anti-Harassment and Teen Dating Violence (4.30.060-P)
- Title IX Student-to-Student Sex-Based Discrimination and Harassment (4.30.063-AD)
- Transgender, Nonbinary and Gender Diverse Students (4.30.061-AD)
- Harassment, Sexual Violence, and Teen Dating Violence (4.30.071-AD)

The policy is also informed by the Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child (WSCC) model and applicable federal and state requirements, including Oregon statutes, administrative rules, and federal school nutrition requirements.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

The proposed revision to Board Policy 6.40.013-P establishes a single, coherent policy framework for student and staff health and wellness consistent with the Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child (WSCC) model. The current policy structure addresses comprehensive health education and student wellness through separate policy documents, which can result in overlapping policy direction and fragmented implementation. The new approach more accurately reflects the interconnected conditions that support student health, engagement, attendance, and academic success.

The proposed revision also establishes a governance and accountability structure not present in the existing policy framework. The Superintendent would appoint a District Wellness Council to advise on wellness-related policies, establish roles and timelines through an annual Wellness Action Plan, assess implementation, and recommend continuous improvement.

Rescission of Board Policy 3.60.060-P is appropriate because the substantive subject matter addressed by the policy—student wellness through nutrition and physical activity—is incorporated into the proposed Comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy.

FISCAL IMPACT

The proposed policy itself is not anticipated to create a direct fiscal impact. The policy establishes a framework to coordinate, implement, monitor, and continuously improve existing district wellness responsibilities.

Implementation may require staff time and coordination across instructional, operational, clinical, and administrative departments. The proposed policy does not, by itself, establish new staffing levels, programs, or funding requirements.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Community engagement is an explicit component of the proposed policy. PPS will communicate opportunities for community participation in developing, implementing, reviewing, and updating the Wellness Policy and Wellness Action Plan. Community participation in the District Wellness Council/School Health Advisory Council is one identified engagement mechanism.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

Upon Board approval, staff will transition implementation to the Comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy framework and begin developing and refining the annual Wellness Action Plan.

The District Wellness Council will delineate roles, responsibilities, and actions within the Wellness Action Plan and assess progress toward implementation annually. The District will assess and review the policy every three years and update it as needed.

Implementation should include:

- Establishment or confirmation of the District Wellness Council membership;
- Development of the annual Wellness Action Plan;
- Identification of responsible departments and staff for each WSCC component;
- Establishment of implementation measures and monitoring processes; and
- Periodic review and reporting on progress and recommended improvements.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The proposed policy supports the Board's commitment to equitable student outcomes by establishing equitable access to health education, wellness supports, nutritious food, physical activity, safe and supportive environments, and health services.

The policy also supports student academic success by recognizing the relationship between students' physical and emotional well-being, attendance, engagement, and learning.

The emphasis on continuous improvement, equity, collaboration, and student access provides a districtwide framework for addressing conditions that support students' ability to thrive.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends that the Board:

- Approve the revision of Board Policy 6.40.013, Comprehensive Health Education Policy, as the Comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy
- Rescind Board Policy 3.60.060-P, Student Wellness through Nutrition and Physical Activity

The proposed action establishes a comprehensive and coordinated policy framework for student and staff wellness consistent with the Whole School, Whole Community, Whole Child model. It consolidates related policy provisions, reduces duplication, establishes clearer responsibility for implementation and evaluation, and provides for an annual Wellness Action Plan and ongoing review through a District Wellness Council.

ATTACHMENTS

A. Proposed Board Policy 6.40.013-P, Comprehensive Health & Wellness Policy
B. Current Board Policy 6.40.013-P, Comprehensive Health Education Policy
C. Current Board Policy 3.60.062-P, Student Wellness through Nutrition and Physical Activity